



MOAR!

DEVELOPER:
Insomniac Games

PUBLISHER:
Sony Interactive Entertainment

PLATFORMS:
PS5

PRICE:
₹4,999

being the lack of varying boss battles.

GRAPHICS

Ratchet and Clank: Rift Apart looks like a Pixar movie. For a large part of our review, we played the game in 4K 30FPS with Ray-Tracing enabled and the experience was cinematic and sublime. Considering the number of effects on screen, large groups of enemies and your weapons firing all over the place, I did not notice the game stutter at all - an incredible technical achievement. From the neon-lit Nefarious City to vast open deserts the game has a lot of diverse environments you can traverse and each looks amazing.

The effects your guns produce are also a sight to behold. From the flashing muzzle of the Enforcer to the lighting generated when you shock an enemy, and even flash of the grenade, on a good HDR TV, you can truly enjoy the dynamic range the game brings to the table.

The character models deserve special attention too, especially Ratchet and Rivet. From their fur looking real-

istically wet in the rain to the Lombax's ears fluttering when grinding on a rail or using hover boots, there are many small touches that add to the immersion. Animation movies have a lot of physical comedy and the same is expressed in the game, especially in a lot of

sequences involving Dr. Nefarious. Eagle eyed gamers will also notice the ray-tracing effects implemented on Clank's shiny body. The devil lies in the details, and the details here are very impressive.

The load times also deserve special mentions and if you skip a cinematic, the game loads in a heartbeat eliminating the era of loading screens being hidden behind cutscenes. Jumping through Rifts is a highlight where the PS5's SSD gets to flex its muscles.

During our review of the game, we played it in the 4K 30 FPS mode with Ray-tracing enabled as that was the only mode available. But the developer has unlocked the 60 FPS mode and the 60 FPS + RT mode as well. We've started a new game using the 60 FPS

+ RT mode and so far, its performance is at par with what we experienced in Spider-Man Miles Morales which has the same modes.

SOUND

Moving over to sound, once again, you can expect Pixar level production with the voice acting, background score and sound design. Ratchet and Clank bring their friendly voice with quirky one-liners. But the voice actor of Rivet deserves a special mention. She has done an outstanding job creating a character who is vulnerable, yet has her guard up. She is also approachable and has a caring side to her, even if she doesn't trust Clank the first time, she meets him.

The game makes use of the PS5's 3D audio capabilities as well and with a good headset on, you can make out the bullets whizzing by you and once the action gets intense, the sound can get quite immersive.

As much as I enjoy the 3D audio capability of the game, I recommend you play it with your speakers. That's because the game also utilizes the speakers on the DualSense controller to add either environmental sound effects, effects from your weapons and more. This combined with the haptic feedback on the controller makes for an immersive gaming experience.

VERDICT

Ratchet and Clank doesn't stray far from the formula that made it a great platformer action game. I miss the fact that Rift Apart doesn't have the double innuendo titles like Going Commando, Up Your Arsenal, and Quest for Booty the franchise started out with. It's more straightforward and takes calculated risks the developers know will pay off. It is a visually stunning game with a diverse arsenal of weapons. The game definitely highlights the abilities of the PS5. The story of the game is full of heart. We would have loved to see more diversity in the boss fights, but the package on offer is one that will definitely appeal to gamers old and young. *